hūmānus

update since 29 June · Q3 2026 Board Meeting

29 October 2026

Humanising Justice

ACCOUNTABILITY · COMMUNITY · EVIDENCE

Sponsor: Eva Buzo, Executive Director · Agenda item TBC · 15 minutes · Discussion · DRAFT for ED sign-off

Three goals guide everything we do

Our 2024–29 strategy frames the year.

1

Victims secure outcomes in line with their own conception of justice.

2

Victims are empowered by the process of pursuing justice — not just by its results.

3

Justice processes are transformed to put victims at the centre.

The September retreat broadened our framing from serious international crimes to human rights violations (slide 9).

Where the work has sat since June

29 June – 12 October 2026, by funded programme and other significant strands.

Programme / strand	Funder
Rohingya in India — legal protection	Core funding
Rohingya dialogue — Bangladesh and Arakan	FCDO (UK) and Swiss FDFA, via Stimson Center
Accountability for business and human rights	Core funding
Public engagement	Core funding

Rohingya in India — legal protection

Core funded · no project grant · Lead: Arati Ranade, India Programme Manager

What the strand is

Direct legal intervention for detained Rohingya refugees in India, building a cross-state network of lawyers and an evidentiary base on detention and deportation patterns. Funded from core — no donor restriction on case selection or strategy.

Since 29 June

- Delhi detention roundtable (5 July) — lawyers from across states convened over three panels to discuss detention litigation strategy.
- Right to Education — strategy note drafted on an education-rights route for detained minors, alongside the refugee route; raised with African states in Geneva (25 August).
- Litigation pipeline — habeas corpus petition in drafting; bail application being finalised for counsel's review; Right to Information petitioner being identified.
- Lawyer network — Jammu & Kashmir leads in place; Rajasthan, Tripura and Hyderabad being assessed. Case-law report on Rohingya deportation in preparation.



Delhi, July 2026

Rohingya dialogue — Bangladesh and Arakan

FCDO (UK) and Swiss FDFA, via Stimson Center as prime · hūmānus as implementing partner

What the project is

Sustained dialogue and engagement with Rohingya leadership, building trust among Rohingya, Arakanese and Bangladesh stakeholders through bilateral engagement, capacity building and facilitated dialogue. FCDO and Swiss FDFA funding support the same project; both reimburse in arrears.

Since 29 June

- Dialogue work continuing with Rohingya leadership.
- FCDO — hūmānus inputs being prepared for the Stimson-led interim report (June–October); June–October claim in GBP and Schedule 2 disbursement amounts being agreed.
- Swiss FDFA — head grant and approved joint workplan requested from Stimson.
- Analysis — ten reports by Sawyadullah on Rohingya relationships with the United States, China, Bangladesh, India and Pakistan, to aid the dialogue and support Rohingya leadership. Website launching November 2026; a workshop on the content will be run in the Rohingya language.

Accountability for business and human rights

Core funded · legal action, regulatory complaint and advocacy — confirmed as a core model at the retreat

THE FRAMEWORK

Bringing together our work that holds business actors accountable for contribution to, or benefit from, serious international crimes — across litigation, regulatory complaint, and investor-facing advocacy.

ACTIVE WORKSTREAMS

Meta / Facebook

Meta has responded to our case, including a request for particulars. [Eva to confirm: source to be supplied] Documentary narrative and video series in production.

Adani

Coordination and investigation work continuing, including research on Australian super-fund exposure, fiduciary-duty case law, the OFAC civil probe and Adani Defence.

Other accountability work

US and UK greenwashing opinions (Reuben brothers / Escénica) in progress. CERD / ICJ brief concerning Australia in preparation.

Note for the Board

At Q2 we proposed a dedicated Adani paper for this meeting. Coordination and investigation work is continuing; the board is updated through this report.

Public engagement

Core funded · Against the Tide, speaking, advocacy and donor relations

Against the Tide

- Eva Buzo Swim × Small Islands Coalition (28 August); Islands Swim: Seychelles (15 September); small-islands press, social and documentary session at UNGA (25 September).
- The swim supported the Esencia NO VA environmental campaign, with a public panel and press coverage (El Vocero).

Speaking and advocacy

- Berkeley (28 September) — keynote, Human Rights for Victims of Conflict in a Fragmenting World; session with Berkeley IIS clinic students on conflict monitoring.
  Recording: youtu.be/_d9m1Zl0Pro
- Amnesty × hūmānus side event at UNGA (25 September).

Donor relations

- OSF partner retreat, Mexico — Finding Each Other on Shifting Ground, bringing together around 100 OSF partners; good connections made. Preceded by online pre-gathering sessions in July.



Esencia NO VA panel


El Vocero interview

Further activities

Advisory work outside our funded programmes

Since 29 June

- Australian war crimes, victim participation — advice to two sets of clients in Australia on victim participation in prosecutions of alleged war crimes committed in Afghanistan.
- Caste-based discrimination — advice on a complaint to the Australian Human Rights Commission against a New South Wales local council, concerning discrimination against Dalit, Bahujan and Adivasi communities. Instructed September 2026.

Strategy retreat — what we decided

Team retreat, September 2026 · strategy, impact and organisational focus

Strategy and impact

- Plan from what clients need — an outcomes ladder linking litigation, mediation and community engagement to meaningful results.
- Broaden the framing from serious international crimes to human rights violations; stay people-focused and prioritise systemic change.
- Corporate accountability — legal action, regulatory complaints and advocacy — adopted as a core model, including Adani and Facebook.
- Rohingya — continue the lawyer-network and coordination approach, and take stock of progress after six months.

Priorities

- Keep excellence, rigour and clear accountability central; new geographies only where needs-driven.
- Tell the organisation's story well and show impact to clients and funders; consider dedicated fundraising capacity.



Team retreat, September 2026

Strategic outlook and watch-items

Things to keep in view between now and the February 2027 meeting.

Cash position

Cash USD 33,679 at 30 September (Q3 management accounts, unaudited); no contracted receipts until the FCDO Phase II claim (indicatively November) and OSF Year 3 (January 2027).

Strategic framing

The retreat broadened the framing of the board-approved 2024–29 strategy from serious international crimes to human rights violations — brought to the board for discussion.

Rohingya work

Progress to be taken stock of around March 2027, between board meetings; the ED will report the outcome to the board.

Fundraising and post-OSF horizon

Dedicated fundraising capacity under consideration — continues the Q2 item 6 discussion on matching ambition to fundraising.

Governance and entity

Legal name change VAI → hūmānus notified to OSF grant contacts; staff contract renewals in progress.

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Q3 2026 Board Meeting · Operations & Impact Update · Sponsor: Eva Buzo (ED) · DRAFT